

MARTINASLOVAKIAEDITEdfinal

Travel Radio Australia, we are visiting Slovakia. What a beautiful country and I'm here with Martina Karakova who is the head of the events department and the marketing section of the Slovakian government, the tourism board and Martina, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, thanks for that.

It's lovely to talk to you and Slovakia has been on my bucket list for many many years being a current skier, an ex-skier, there's a fantastic ski resorts and all sorts of things. Can you give us an overview of the country for our listeners who've never been there and tell them what they can expect when they come to Slovakia? Well Slovakia is not a very large country, it's got only 49 000 square kilometers so you can imagine it's a quite a small country but it's very sweet, situated located right in the heart of Europe so it's accessible very easily from all around the neighboring countries so our neighboring countries are Hungary, Austria, Vienna, the biggest amount of flight connections are in Vienna, it's a Vienna hub so you can take a flight from Australia to Vienna and easily get to Bratislava, the capital city of Slovakia which is only 45 minutes away, no borders so once you actually fly to Europe it's like a Schengen zone so you can easily walk around and travel around and visit other countries. Prague is very close, Czech Republic, Poland, Warsaw, it's like a very compact place and connected and there's loads to see.

Slovakia is like as I said small, not really large in terms of the area, when you fly to Vienna and you go to Bratislava and you basically maybe you can hire a car for example and you travel across the country you get to the one side from the west to the east very easily very quickly and you see loads of beautiful things the country's opening up in front of you from the little valleys you go to the mountains which are right in the middle in the middle of the country and we have lovely ski resorts especially during winter we still got some snow because you know it's snow is starting to be a little bit of a problem with the global warming unfortunately but we'll still have the snow and we have very nice ski resorts especially in High Tatras. High Tatras it's a mountain region that is the highest peak is 2644 meters above the sea level it's very well done it's like modern very nice nice resorts we have with very nice hotels accommodation wellness facilities and all that restaurants you can have a very nice pleasurable time there there's a mountain area and you can see loads of beautiful things let's walk around in the mountains all year round really during winter during summer experience lovely food we have very nice wine for example in Slovakia we have really nice white wine red wine so we have lots of great winery production it's very good one as well so yeah it's a it's a different it's different country in comparison with Australia so it's very it's good to see it's good to come and visit and experience something new for you. Tell us about the ski resorts because we have a lot of skiers in Australia because we have nine ski resorts of our own in Australia a lot of people don't know that and tell us about some of the resorts in general is there a main one or a couple of big ones and some satellite ones as well most famous one is Jasna in low Tetris it's the center is the mountain called Khopok and that's one of the very very well equipped and well done it's one of the most famous ones resorts Jasna Jasna it means

it's a word it's like bright Jasni means like bright so it's like a bright resort Jasna also we have in high Tetris as well we have a nice resorts we've played several resorts but these are around Strbske Pleso there are some some resorts as well very very good ones and this Jasna Khopok is one of the one of the best well equipped.

Now I did do a trip once from Sweden down through Prague and I did drop in at Bratislava come think of it I remember now and I do remember that the restaurants there are absolutely fantastic and the prices are really good compared to the rest of Europe because you can get a beautiful meal there for very little money and I have to say that we somehow getting even better in in cuisine or in in making nice meals this area is like developing and in a very good way we have so many nice restaurants which are really worth visiting and you have to be there for a while and sit sit down have a really nice meal and yes the prices are maybe a bit better I mean it's everywhere in Europe the prices are going higher they are higher than they used to be in the past but it's still when you compare them the prices with other countries is still yes it's still better value for money in Slovakia so that's why Slovakia is visited by tourists and we're here at the international golf travel market and and the thing is you've got great golf courses there too yes exactly yeah around Bratislava we have several very good quality golf courses for example like Panati, Hrubá Borša or Sedin as are the names of them yeah but also we have very very nice resort golf resorts in the high Tatras in the mountain region as I mentioned for example like Black Stork one of the best ones Thale as well that's another great resort yes these resorts are equipped with accommodation wellness facilities the the greens have 18 holes nine holes combination of 18 and nine holes so it's a very good quality service as well so yes it's well worth visiting now I'm speaking with Martina Kavakova who is the head of events department for the marketing section for Slovakia travel which is the government organization for travel across Slovakia and tell us about this organization you handle a lot of things you have all the incoming tourists and that sort of thing yeah exactly we specialize in incoming that's what usually governmental entities do that yeah our main job is to attract tourists from abroad and to promote Slovakia in the best way in the best light abroad that's my job what we do we build the stands all around Europe and sometimes around the world and we actually we build the stands of the travel fairs for example like WTM in London IGTM here around well in different places or also ITB in Berlin so we do participate with travel fairs and to show that Slovakia is here and is ready for you guys to come to Slovakia and I always ask this a couple of your hidden gems that you would recommend to people a bit off the beaten track what would you say to someone who maybe is in Bratislava and and wants to check out something really special well definitely when you travel to Europe as I said are you you fly to Vienna and then you come to the capital city Bratislava which is not like very large city somebody once explained it to me it was a tourist from abroad he said oh I love Bratislava because like a hometown so it's cozy and it's got very nice city center it's like old fashion or we have very nice like buildings the architecture is like historical buildings we have and so that's very nice to stay in the city you can stay in a hotel and walk the streets what's really good about Slovakia is very safe and you don't have to be worried to walk around even at midnight one o'clock in the morning so especially during summer time which is the best season is from May to October it's very pleasant

to stay in in Bratislava and also as I mentioned high Tatras in the mountain region very good hotels and there's plenty to see you can walk around beautiful sceneries and lovely lakes it's mountain lakes maybe you didn't know that in Slovakia we have more than 7 000 caves we have really beautiful caves only few of them are open to public but they're well worth visiting we have some ice caves there's only seven I think around seven ice caves in the world well we have three they're on a UNESCO heritage list and of course I have to mention also we have very beautiful castles shuttles castle ruins which are also on the list on a UNESCO world heritage which are worth visiting for sure definitely so much to see and do in Martina Kovakova who's with Slovakia travel the government organization for Slovakia how can people find out more about Slovakia the country online well definitely we have our own website the website www.slovakia.travel where you can find a lot more information you can find us on Facebook you can find us on LinkedIn and also on Instagram so yes please visit all these social media and you can find a lot more information about Slovakia or just visit us come to Slovakia definitely for our Slovakian friends in Australia and we have quite a few in Australia can you say hi to them in Slovakia for us You will show us Slovakia and you will bring with you other friends from Australia who will visit Slovakia and we will be very happy about it. Greetings! Sounds great Martina thank you very much for being on the program thank you very much I really am grateful for this opportunity I'm saying hello to all the listeners I really would like to invite you to Slovakia and I'm looking forward to seeing you there see you see you bye thank you